



1870

CONSTRUCTION BEGINS ON THE BROOKLYN BRIDGE, NEW YORK

Linking New York and Brooklyn across the East River, the Brooklyn Bridge was the world's longest suspension bridge at the time of construction. The work on was overseen by Emily Roebling, wife of the bridge's designer, John A. Roebling, who died following a freak accident in 1869. Carrying a rooster in her arms, Emily was the first to cross the bridge when it opened on 24 May 1883.

< Construction workers on the unfinished bridge

The Brooklyn Bridge is 1,834 m (6,016 ft) long and 83 m (272 ft) high

1870

1871 Gold is discovered

in South Africa following the discovery of diamonds there in 1867

1872 American suffragette

Susan B. Anthony votes in the US election and is arrested

1872 Louis Ducos du Hauron, a French physicist, pioneers modern colour photography

1871 Rome becomes part of the kingdom of Italy, finishing the process of reunification

1872 YELLOWSTONE, THE WORLD'S FIRST NATIONAL PARK, OPENS

After photographs and paintings of Yellowstone helped raise interest in the area's unique natural wonders, President Ulysses S. Grant signed the Yellowstone National Park Protection Act into law on 1 March 1872. It withdrew the "headwaters of the Yellowstone River" from "settlement, occupancy, or sale" and made the area a "public park or pleasuring-ground for the benefit and enjoyment of the people".

▷ Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone River

